

Data Collection Guide — Australian Battery Industry Analysis

What to collect, where to find it, and how

A practical companion to the Industry Analysis Plan. For each phase, this tells you the exact data you need, the real source (with the actual organisation/portal name), and how to get it. Sources verified current as of mid-2026.

Educational resource, not investment advice. Always check each source's own date and terms before relying on it.

How to read this guide

The data splits into two kinds, and you need both:

Kind	What it is	Example
Industry data	Public information about the whole sector	How many battery projects are in the pipeline
Company data	Private information about <i>this specific opportunity</i>	This company's actual sites, approvals, and pipeline

You gather **industry data** yourself from public sources (this guide shows you where). You gather **company data** by *asking the company directly* — through a due-diligence request list and a data room (a secure folder they give you access to). Both are covered below.

A golden rule for the whole exercise: for every important number, note its **source and date**. In a fast-moving sector, a figure from 18 months ago can be badly wrong. An investment committee will ask "says who, and as of when?" — have the answer ready.

The free official sources you'll use most (your core toolkit)

These are the real, authoritative, mostly-free Australian sources. Bookmark them.

Source	What it gives you	Cost
AEMO (Australian Energy Market Operator)	The master data on the grid, project pipeline, connections, and the long-term plan	Free
NSW Planning Portal	Every NSW major battery project's approval status and documents	Free
Victorian planning system (Engage Victoria / DTP)	VIC battery project planning and approvals	Free
AER (Australian Energy Regulator)	Market rules, network regulation, wholesale market reports	Free
Clean Energy Regulator	Rebate schemes, certificates (STCs), accredited installers	Free
Clean Energy Council	Industry reports, the battery storage report, member data	Mostly free
CEFC (Clean Energy Finance Corporation)	What the government green bank is funding (signals buyer demand)	Free
State energy departments (NSW DCCEE, VIC DEECA)	State schemes, targets, revenue-support programs	Free

Phase 1 — Data to define the industry and business model

This data comes mostly from the company, not public sources. You're pinning down exactly what they do.

Data you need	Where / how to get it
Exact size of each "small battery station" (MW and MWh)	Ask the company — request their project list
Connection type (transmission vs distribution network)	Company documents; cross-check on AEMO's connection register
What's sold at exit (development rights / built asset / operating asset)	Ask the company directly — this is a core question
Number of projects (single vs a pipeline)	Company's pipeline schedule
The legal/corporate structure of what you'd invest in	Company's information memorandum + legal documents

How to ask: create a **due-diligence request list** (a written list of documents and questions) and ask the company to populate a **data room**. Phase 1 items belong at the top of that list.

What "good" looks like: you can state, in one sentence, exactly what the company builds, where, at what scale, connected how, and sold at what stage. If you can't get clear answers, that itself is a finding.

Phase 2 — Data to size the market and the exit market

2a. Size the storage need (the demand)

Data you need	Source	How to get it
National storage requirement to 2050	AEMO Integrated System Plan (ISP)	Download the latest ISP PDF from aemo.com.au (free). The ISP is <i>the</i> authoritative long-term roadmap — it states how much storage the grid needs and when.
NSW and VIC state storage targets	NSW DCCEEW and VIC DEECA energy strategy pages	State government websites; search "NSW electricity infrastructure roadmap" and "Victoria renewable energy storage target"
How much capacity is already committed vs still needed (the gap)	AEMO ISP + AEMO Generation Information file	The gap between "needed" and "committed" is the opportunity size — calculate it yourself
Quarterly snapshots of what's happening now	AEMO Quarterly Energy Dynamics (QED) report	Free PDF, published quarterly — gives the latest capacity, prices, and trends

2b. Size the project pipeline (the competition + the supply)

Data you need	Source	How to get it
Every battery project in the connection pipeline	AEMO Generation Information file	Download the spreadsheet from AEMO's "Generation Information" page (free, updated ~quarterly). Lists existing, committed, and proposed projects by region — filter for NSW and VIC batteries
Project connection progress and timing	AEMO Connections Scorecard and Key Connection Information (KCI) list	Published on AEMO's site — tracks how projects move through the connection process and how long it takes

2c. Size the exit market (the buyers) — the most important for a flip

Data you need	Source	How to get it
Who is actively buying battery assets, and recent deals	Industry trade press	Energy-Storage.news, pv magazine Australia, RenewEconomy, ESD News — search recent battery acquisition announcements
What government green capital is funding	CEFC and Energy Security Corporation announcements	Their websites list investments — a direct signal of buyer appetite
Infrastructure fund / super fund activity	Fund press releases (Palisade, CIP, Quinbrook); super fund (Aware Super, HESTA) media	Company news pages; trade press

Top-down vs bottom-up (do both):

- *Top-down*: (NSW + VIC storage target) × (share likely to be small/distributed) = your market size.
- *Bottom-up*: (realistic number of viable sites) × (average MWh) × (value per MWh from recent deals) = cross-check. If the two roughly agree, you can trust the number. If they're wildly apart, find out why.

Phase 3 — Data for the three CFA frameworks

3a. Industry life cycle

Data you need	Source
Growth rate of the sector	AEMO ISP + market-research reports (IMARC, Mordor Intelligence, BloombergNEF if accessible)
Number and stage of competitors	AEMO Generation Information pipeline; trade press
How fast capacity is being added	AEMO QED quarterly reports

3b. Porter's Five Forces (developer lens)

Force	Data you need	Source
New entrants	How many developers are competing; how scarce are grid slots	AEMO connection pipeline (counts the competitors); developer announcements
Supplier power	Battery cell prices and availability; EPC contractor market	BloombergNEF battery price surveys; trade press; ask the company who their suppliers are
Buyer power	How concentrated the buyer pool is	Your Phase 2c buyer list — few buyers = high buyer power
Substitutes	Pumped hydro, gas, home-battery/VPP competition	AEMO ISP (shows the full storage mix)
Rivalry	Number of competing projects per region	AEMO Generation Information, filtered by region

3c. PESTLE

Letter	Data you need	Source
Political	Federal & state support schemes (Capacity Investment Scheme, NSW LTESA, VIC programs)	DCCEEW (federal & NSW), VIC DEECA, AER

Letter	Data you need	Source
Economic	Interest rates; electricity price volatility	RBA (for rates); AEMO QED (for power prices)
Social	Community attitudes / objections to specific sites	NSW Planning Portal project pages — read the public submissions (see Phase 5 note)
Technological	Battery cost trends; duration trends (shift to 4-hour+)	BloombergNEF; CSIRO GenCost report (free); trade press
Legal	Planning rules; grid connection rules; safety standards	NSW Planning (State Significant Development pathway); AEMO connection rules; AER
Environmental	Site/land/fire/recycling issues	EPBC Act referrals (federal DCCEEW); project EIS documents

Free gem: the **CSIRO GenCost** report (published annually with AEMO) gives authoritative Australian cost data for batteries and other technologies. Excellent, citable, free.

Phase 4 — Data for the PE screen

Most of this you've already gathered in Phases 2–3. You're now *scoring* it. The two items you still need are company-specific:

Screen criterion	Data you need	Source
Repeatable pipeline	The company's forward pipeline of projects	Company data room
Capital required before sale	The company's funding plan and cash-flow timing	Company financial model + information memorandum

Phase 5 — Data for the two make-or-break risks

This is where you spend the most effort. Much of it is **company data** (from the data room) cross-checked against **public data**.

Risk A — Execution risk data

Data you need	Where / how
Planning approval status of each project	NSW Planning Portal → Major Projects / Application Tracker (free, real-time): search the project name to see its exact status, documents, and timeline. For VIC: the Victorian planning system / Engage Victoria. <i>Cross-check what the company tells you against the public record.</i>
Typical approval timelines and success rates	Browse multiple completed BESS projects on the NSW Planning Portal — see how long each took from lodgement to determination. This gives you a realistic benchmark.
Community objection risk	Read the public submissions on the NSW Planning Portal project pages. Many BESS projects attract significant objections (fire/safety, land use, property values). Heavy objection = approval delay risk. This is real, readable data.
Grid connection status	Ask the company for connection agreements/correspondence; cross-check against AEMO's connection pipeline and the network operator (in NSW: Ausgrid/Endeavour/Essential or Transgrid; in VIC: the relevant distribution business).
Site control (own/lease)	Company data room — land titles, leases, options
Team track record	Company — management CVs; cross-check against past projects in trade press and planning records
EPC / construction plan	Company — construction contracts, cost estimates

Risk B — Exit risk data

Data you need	Where / how
Who the buyers are	Phase 2c buyer list
What stage/structure buyers pay for	Trade-press deal write-ups — read <i>how</i> recent deals were structured (e.g. sold at construction stage, with a tolling agreement attached)
Comparable transaction prices ("comps")	Trade press (Energy-Storage.news, pv magazine, ESD News); deal-tracker services (Enerdatix, Mergermarket) if accessible. Record: project size, stage, contract status, and price

Data you need	Where / how
Whether projects will have a revenue contract at sale	Ask the company — do they intend to secure a tolling agreement or offtake before sale?

The single most decisive data point for a flip: evidence of *what buyers are actually paying for right now*. The current signal is that capital favours **de-risked, contracted, construction-ready** assets over speculative early-stage pipelines. You confirm (or challenge) this by reading the last 6–12 months of actual deal announcements.

Phase 6 — Data for buyers and comparable deals

Data you need	Source	How
A named list of 3–4+ active buyers	Trade press + CEFC/ESC sites	Build it as you research Phase 2c and 5b
Recent comparable sales (size, stage, price, contract)	Trade press; deal trackers	Compile into a simple comps table
Buyer mandates (what each buyer targets)	Fund websites; their press releases	Read their stated investment focus

Build a comps table like this as you go:

Project	Size (MW/MWh)	Stage at sale	Contract?	Buyer	Approx. price	Date
<i>(fill from announcements)</i>						

This table is gold for both the industry verdict *and* later valuation (Modules 2–4).

Phase 7 — Data for the write-up

By now you have everything. Phase 7 is synthesis, not new collection. The one thing to add:

Data you need	Source
Any final sanity-checks on your numbers	Re-verify your 3–5 most important figures against their original sources and dates

The company due-diligence request list (what to ask for)

For the **company-specific** data above, send the company a written request. A starter list:

- ☐ Full project pipeline (each project: location, size in MW/MWh, connection type, current stage)
- ☐ Planning approval status and documents for each project
- ☐ Grid connection agreements or application correspondence
- ☐ Site control evidence (titles, leases, options)
- ☐ Management team CVs and track record
- ☐ The financial model (capital in, timing, expected sale proceeds)
- ☐ Information memorandum / investment teaser
- ☐ Intended exit stage and any buyer discussions to date
- ☐ Whether revenue contracts (tolling/offtake) are planned or secured
- ☐ Corporate and legal structure of the investment
- ☐ Key contracts (EPC, equipment supply)

Always cross-check. Anything the company tells you about approvals or connections, verify against the **public** record (NSW Planning Portal, AEMO). Where the company's account and the public record agree, your confidence rises. Where they differ, you've found a question worth asking — which is exactly the kind of diligence rigour your credit background trains you for.

How to organise the data (a simple system)

- ☐ **One folder per phase** (1-7), mirroring this guide
 - ☐ **One master spreadsheet** with a tab for: key figures (+ source + date), the pipeline, the comps table, and the framework scorecards
 - ☐ **A source log** — every figure gets a row: the number, where it came from, and the date
 - ☐ **A "questions for the company" running list** — every gap you can't fill from public data
 - ☐ **Update the AEMO and planning-portal data once more** right before you finalise, since both refresh regularly
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Quick-reference: the 10 sources that do 80% of the work

1. **AEMO Integrated System Plan (ISP)** — how much storage the grid needs, long-term
2. **AEMO Generation Information file** — the full project pipeline (existing/committed/proposed)

3. **AEMO Connections Scorecard / Key Connection Information** — connection progress and timing
 4. **AEMO Quarterly Energy Dynamics (QED)** — latest quarterly trends and prices
 5. **NSW Planning Portal (Major Projects / Application Tracker)** — approval status, documents, and public submissions
 6. **Victorian planning system (Engage Victoria / DTP)** — VIC approvals
 7. **CSIRO GenCost** — authoritative battery cost data (free)
 8. **CEFC + Energy Security Corporation** — what government green capital funds (buyer-demand signal)
 9. **Energy trade press** (Energy-Storage.news, pv magazine Australia, RenewEconomy) — deals, buyers, comps
 10. **The company's own data room** — everything project-specific
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Source names and structures (AEMO ISP, Generation Information, Connections Scorecard, QED; NSW Planning Portal; CEFC; CSIRO GenCost; AER; Clean Energy Regulator) verified current as of mid-2026. Availability and exact titles can change — confirm at each source. This is an educational resource for conducting your own analysis, not investment advice; I am not a licensed financial adviser.